side window): Do you think we had better remove Great-aunt Cicely?

WESTON: In the name of heaven, why?

LADY WESTON: She is in the direct line of shots coming through that window.

WESTON: And why should any shots come through the window, may I ask?

LADY WESTON (*mildly objecting to the tone*): I was merely taking thought for your property, my dear Richard. And anyone sitting in the ilex tree out there would be in a –

WESTON (*on his feet*): Frances! What made you think of the **ilex tree**?

LADY WESTON: That is where I would shoot you from. I mean, if I were going to shoot you. The leaves are thick enough to hide anyone sitting there, and yet not enough to obscure their view.

WESTON: Come away from that window.

LADY WESTON: What?

WESTON: Come away from that window!

LADY WESTON (moving to him): No one is going to shoot me.

WESTON (*running out of the room, and calling to ROGER from the landing*): Roger! Roger!

ROGER (*very distant*): My lord?

WESTON: Has the gardener gone away yet?

ROGER: No, my lord. He is eating his dinner outside the kitchen window.

WESTON: Tell him to sit under the ilex tree until I give him leave to move.

ROGER: The ilex tree? Yes, my lord.

(*WESTON comes back and goes to the drawer of the table where his pistol is kept.*)

LADY WESTON (*as he takes out the pistol*): Oh Richard dear, be careful. That is a very dangerous weapon.

WESTON (*grimly important*): I know it!

LADY WESTON: Well, I think it is a poor way **to foil** an assassin.

WESTON: What is?

LADY WESTON: Blowing oneself up.

(*Enter ROGER with the bowl of daffodils.*)

WESTON (*looking round at him as he comes in*): Has Joel gone to sit under the tree?

ROGER: Yes, sir. (*Put thing down the bowl and making for the side window*) At least, I gave him your message –

WESTON: Keep away from that window! (*As ROGER looks astonished*) There may be someone in the ilex tree.

ROGER: But do you think they would try to shoot you as well as – as…. (*he indicates the bucket.*)

WESTON: Who knows? When you have dealt with the criminal mind as long as I have… Did you open the door to speak to the gardener?

ROGER: Oh, no, my lord. I spoke through the shutter.

WESTON(*snapping the lock of his pistol*): Now we shall see whether there is anyone lurking in the tree. (*He moves over to the side of the window, peering out with the fraction of an eye.*)

12th General_English_Unit_6_C_Supplementary.indd 203 07-12-2021 18:21:05